

smell and taste

dorsum of tongue

epiglottitis
Movable cartilaginous plate ensuring that the larynx closes during ingestion of food so that food cannot enter the respiratory tract.

lingual tonsil
Lymphoid structure (rich in white blood cells) located at the base of the tongue; it assists in immune defense.

palatine tonsil
Lymphoid structure (rich in white blood cells) located on each side of the base of the tongue; it protects the respiratory tract by fighting bacteria.

foramen cecum
Small depression located at the base of the tongue, at the top of the sulcus terminalis.

root
Part that fixes the tongue to the mandible and the hyoid bone of the skull; it is also joined on each side to the walls of the pharynx.

sulcus terminalis
Inverted V-shaped depression separating the base of the body of the tongue, topped by the foramen cecum.

circumvallate papilla
Each of the large taste buds (about 10) forming a lingual V at the back of the body of the tongue ensuring the taste function; they mostly perceive bitter flavors.

body
Free mobile portion of the tongue composed mostly of mucous-covered muscles and bearing the taste buds.

median lingual sulcus
Depression extending over the entire length of the body of the tongue and separating it into two symmetrical halves.

apex
Mobile terminal end of the tongue; it mostly perceives sweet flavors.

